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Initiate payment API

API type	REST
Latest version	Version 1.0 - beta
Last updated	19 June 2026
Sandbox base URL	https://test-api.service.hmrc.gov.uk
Production base URL	https://api.service.hmrc.gov.uk

Overview

This API allows third party accounting software providers to:

- send users to GOV.UK to start a payment journey with HMRC
- prepopulate the user's reference and amount in the payment journey
- find out the status of the user's payment journey (for example, if the payment was completed, scheduled, cancelled or unsuccessful)

Errors

We use standard HTTP status codes to show whether an API request succeeded or not. They are usually in the range:

- 200 to 299 if it succeeded, including code 202 if it was accepted by an API that needs to wait for further action
- 400 to 499 if it failed because of a client error by your application
- 500 to 599 if it failed because of an error on our server

Errors specific to each API are shown in the Endpoints section, under Response. See our [reference guide](#) for more on errors.

Testing

You can use the [HMRC Developer Sandbox](#) to test the API. The Sandbox is an enhanced testing service that functions as a simulator of HMRC's production environment.

You will need to follow these steps to test the full journeys:

- Make sure to pay no more than £10 in a single transaction
- Select Coutts sandbox on select bank screen
- Sign in with username "alice"
- Enter password "secret"
- Select either account that has enough balance for the transaction
- Continue through to be redirected back to HMRC confirmation screen

Versioning

When an API changes in a way that is backwards-incompatible, we increase the version number of the API. See our [reference guide](#) for more on versioning.

Endpoints

Version	Environments	Endpoints
Version 1.0 - beta (opens in new tab)	Sandbox and Production	1.0 endpoints
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